

Cybercrime Case Study: UPI Payment Fraud Among College Students

Introduction

With the rapid growth of digital payments in India, UPI has become one of the most commonly used transaction methods among college students. Apps like Google Pay, PhonePe, and Paytm make payments fast and convenient. However, this convenience has also led to an increase in cyber fraud.

Case Scenario

Imagine a college student selling a used smartwatch through an online marketplace. A buyer quickly shows interest and agrees to purchase the item without bargaining. Instead of sending the payment, the fraudster sends a UPI collect request and claims that approving it is necessary to receive money.

Step-by-Step Modus Operandi

-  Fraudster contacts the victim.
-  Gains trust.
-  Sends collect request.
-  Victim enters UPI PIN.
-  Money is transferred.

Target Audience

-  College students
-  New UPI users
-  Online marketplace sellers

Consequences

-  Instant financial loss
-  Emotional stress
-  Risk of repeated fraud

Preventive Insights

-  Never enter PIN to receive money
-  Check request type carefully
-  Report fraud at cybercrime.gov.in or call 1930

Conclusion

This case highlights how lack of awareness can lead to financial fraud. Proper digital literacy and careful verification can help students stay safe online.